are either holding or subsidiary company of a public company shall be limited to 10. Further the members of a company may restrict above mentioned limit by passing a special resolution.

If a person holds Directorship in more than the limit specified above he/she has to resign the excess, according to his / her choice.

If a person accepts an appointment as a director in excess of above mentioned limit is punishable with a fine of not less than Rs. 5,000 but which may extend to Rs. 25,000 for every day after the first day for the period of Directorship hold by the person.

27.06 Legal Position of Director

Directors are the persons duly appointed by the Company to lead and manage its affairs and their legal position. At times they have to act as agents, managing partner, trustees, Employee, and Officer.

Directors as Agents: A company as an artificial person, acts through directors who are elected representatives of the shareholders and who execute decision made for the benefit of shareholders. Hence directors share a relationship of an agent and a principal with the company.

Example 1: XYZ is Chennai based private limited Company which has two directors, Agi and Logu. The company wants to start its business operation in state of Karnataka and for that they need an office accommodation. Agi goes to Karnataka and buys a property in Bangalore to house the office. Although the purchase has been made by Agi the property belongs to the company. Agi has just acted as an agent of the company.

Directors are appointed to lead the company in relation to third parties. They can enjoy the rights and privileges of an agent. There is no personal liability on any contracts entered by them, if it is within the powers stated in the memorandum and articles of the company. If it is not so they have personal liability.

It is also considered that directors are not a full fledged agents of the company because they are elected person but agents are appointed persons.

Directors as Managing Partners

The management of company is vested in the hands of many executives. So, the directors are virtuals managing partners and the Directors elected by shareholders are like partners to the shareholders. However, substantial powers may be entrusted with the directors or to an outsider, such a person has to act under the superintendence, control and direction of the board of Directors. Therefore, unlike in a partnership firm, no power can be delegated to a single director as a managing partner.

Example 2: The same company due to negligence of its Directors fails to pay sales tax to the government. The government files a case against the directors for the recovery of tax payable by the company. As the fault is that of the directors, they are personally liable for the payment of the taxes.

Directors as trustees

Directors are trustees of the company's money and property and they have to safeguard them and use them for the sake of the company and on behalf of the company. According to Law of trust, the equitable ownership of the trust property is vested with the beneficiary only, Hence directors cannot act as a full-fledged trustee.

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